# HERALDRY SKIRMISH

## THE DYING LANDS

*A competitive GM-less PvPvE fantasy tabletop miniature skirmish game*

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**Release Candidate 485 (RC485)**

2.

# Core Mechanics

Heraldry Skirmish uses fixed procedures for uncertainty, movement, visibility, terrain, and resource spending. Uncertain actions use a **Check** against **12**. Unless a rule says otherwise, this section applies to every mode of play.

## 2.1 Core Terms

A **combatant** is any Hero, Hireling, Monster, Summon, or other model that can act on the battlefield.

A **Hero** is a player-controlled adventurer and the primary member of a party.

A **Hireling** is an allied non-Hero combatant whose profile or granting rule identifies them as a Hireling. Hirelings follow the normal rules for combatants unless a rule says otherwise.

A **Monster** is a neutral or hostile non-party combatant controlled by the Monster AI rules.

A **Summon** is a temporary combatant that their creating rule identifies as a Summon. A combatant does not become a Summon merely because a rule places or creates them. In particular, a named bestiary Monster placed by a Monster or scenario rule remains a **Monster** unless that rule explicitly identifies them as a Summon.

A **living combatant** is any combatant that does not have the **Undead** or **Construct** ability.

A **Celestial** is a combatant whose rule gives them the **Celestial** tag. A **Fiend** is a combatant whose rule gives them the **Fiend** tag; the **Fiend** Special Ability grants this tag. Neither tag has an effect by itself; rules that affect Celestials or Fiends say so explicitly.

An **allied** combatant is on your side. An **ally** is another combatant on your side; you are not your own ally. A rule that can affect you says **you**, **yourself**, **self**, or **you or an ally**. An **enemy** combatant is any combatant not on your side, including opposing party combatants and Monsters, unless a rule says a specific combatant is not an enemy for that interaction.

A **party** is one side's allied Heroes and Hirelings. Allied Summons belong to their controlling party for party-wide limits, but are not Heroes, Hirelings, or Roster members.

A **Party Leader** is the Hero designated by a side to anchor that side's Initiative rolls and to make choices assigned to the **Party Leader** by these rules. Each side designates one **Party Leader** as described in **6.1**. A party does not replace its **Party Leader** during an adventure. If the **Party Leader** is not on the battlefield, use **3.2** for Initiative and **6.1** for shared-control authority.

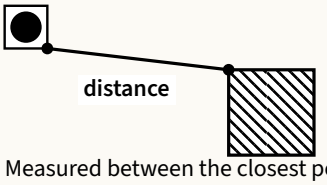
A **target** is the combatant, marker, hazard, terrain feature, or point chosen by a rule or action.

A combatant, marker, hazard, terrain feature, or point is **adjacent** to another when the horizontal distance and vertical separation between the two are each **1"** or less. In **Grid Mode**, the two horizontal positions must overlap or neighbour each other orthogonally or diagonally, and the vertical separation between them must be **1"** or less.

A **space** is the area a combatant, marker, hazard, or terrain feature occupies. A combatant's space is their rules **footprint**, determined by **Sz** under the **Size and Footprints** rules in **2.6**. In **Grid Mode**, it is the square or squares that footprint occupies.

Unless a rule says otherwise, combatants are aware in all directions and do not use facing.

**A** **Tabletop Mode (2.6)**

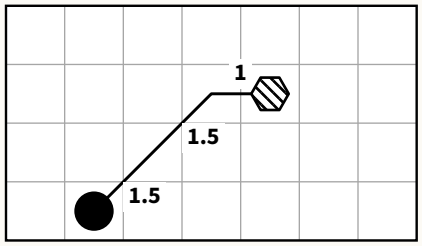



Measured between the closest points of the source and target spaces.

Rules footprints are used, not the miniature's base. Rules that measure from a point use that point.

**Schematic — not to scale**

**B** **Grid Mode: range / distance (2.6)**

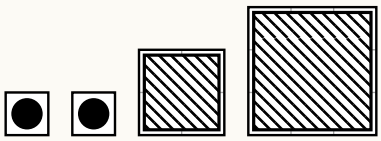



source square

**1.5" + 1.5" + 1" = 4"**

Orthogonal square = 1", diagonal square = 1.5". Count the shortest grid distance without the source square. Obstacles do not change it; check LOS, Cover and terrain separately.

**C** **Grid Mode: footprints (2.6)**




A combatant occupies the squares of their Sz footprint (S and M 1×1, L 2×2, H 3×3). Their whole footprint must fit in every legal final position.

**D** **Declared movement and positional state (2.6.1)**

**1 Declare**
Before voluntary or forced movement, declare the intended path and final position (for placement, the final position).

→

**2 Verify**
An opposing player may measure and verify it. If illegal, amend it or choose another action; an abandoned declaration costs no AP.

→

**3 Move**
Once movement begins, or a Reaction is declared against it, the declaration cannot be amended or abandoned. A triggered Reaction resolves at the first point on the path where its trigger occurs.

→

**4 Declared State**
The actual path and final position become the Declared State until the combatant moves or is moved. If a miniature is moved accidentally, restore it.

**FIG-04.** Tabletop Mode measures between closest points; Grid Mode counts orthogonal squares as 1" and diagonal squares as 1.5", so this range is 1.5 + 1.5 + 1 = 4" without the source square. Footprints follow Sz, and movement is declared and verified before it is resolved (see 2.6).

Track movement and distance in **0.5"** increments. Do not round a **1.5"** diagonal or a combatant's remaining movement.

If a source or target occupies more than one square, check each source-square and target-square pair. When range, **LOS**, and **Cover** apply to the same target or effect, one pair must satisfy all requirements. If more than one pair does, use the pair that grants the target the least **Cover**. If **Cover** is tied, use the shortest range. For a distance that does not also require **LOS** or **Cover**, use the closest occupied squares.

If a rule measures from or to a point, marker, hazard, or terrain feature, use the square containing it unless the rule says otherwise.

**Universal Rounding:** Do not round measured distances, listed fractional distances, or Grid Mode movement tracked in **0.5"** increments. When any other calculation in Heraldry Skirmish produces a fraction, round down to the nearest whole number immediately after that calculation. Rounding down is the default and need not be restated. A rule that requires a different direction must say so explicitly using the phrase **rounded up**.

**Minimum Values:** Except for ability scores, values cannot be reduced below **0** unless a rule explicitly says otherwise.

## Size and Footprints

Every combatant has a **Size (Sz): Small (S), Medium (M), Large (L),** or **Huge (H)**. Published profiles list **Sz** explicitly. If a temporary or generic combatant has no listed Size, treat them as **Medium (Sz M)**.

| Sz | Size | Footprint | Grid Footprint |
|---|---|---|---|
| **S** | Small | **1"×1"** | **1×1 square** |
| **M** | Medium | **1"×1"** | **1×1 square** |
| **L** | Large | **2"×2"** | **2×2 squares** |

3.

# The Game Round

Heraldry Skirmish is played in rounds. Each round has four phases: **Initiative Phase**, **Party Phase**, **Monster Phase**, and **End of Round**.

## 3.1 Overview of a Round

Unless a specific rule changes the order of the **Party Phase** and **Monster Phase**, each round is resolved in the following order:

**Initiative Phase**

- Refresh AP for each combatant on the battlefield with an AP maximum.
- Determine Initiative.
- Resolve start-of-round effects.

**Party Phase**

- Sides alternate activating eligible allied combatants.
- Heroes, Hirelings, and allied Summons act during this phase unless a rule says otherwise.
- Each allied combatant may activate **once per round** while they are eligible.

**Monster Phase**

- Resolve Monster waking rules.
- Activate each **Awake** Monster Group.

**End of Round**

- Resolve end-of-round effects.
- End effects that last **until the end of the round**.
- Remove unspent AP.
- Resolve scenario scoring, extraction, round limits, and victory conditions.

A new round begins after the previous round ends unless the scenario ends first.

If a specific rule places the **Monster Phase** before the **Party Phase**, both phases still resolve once before the **End of Round** begins.

Place the combatant at a legal destination, or a legal destination square in **Grid Mode**, within the listed distance and any listed **LOS** requirement. The destination must have enough legal space for the combatant's footprint and a surface that could normally support them. A combatant cannot teleport into empty air unless they can fly or a rule explicitly allows it. Apply terrain, hazards, **Light**, **Darkness**, **Cover**, and other destination effects after placement.

### 4.4.6 Forced Movement

**Forced movement** is movement caused by a rule rather than chosen by the moved combatant. Forced movement never triggers **Reflex Attack**.

**Push X"** moves the target up to **X"** directly away from the source of the effect or directly away from a specified point.

**Pull X"** moves the target up to **X"** directly toward the source of the effect or directly toward a specified point.

**Slide X"** moves the target up to **X"** in the direction named by the effect.

In **Tabletop Mode**, determine the direction of a **Push** or **Pull** using the straight line between the centres of the source's and target's spaces, or between the specified point and the centre of the target's space. If the centres coincide, the controller of the effect chooses the direction.

In **Grid Mode**, each square of **Push** must increase the target's grid distance from the source or specified point. Each square of **Pull** must decrease that distance. If more than one legal square qualifies, the controller of the effect chooses. **Slide** follows the direction named by the effect; if more than one legal square matches that direction, the controller of the effect chooses.

Forced movement cannot move a target through **Impassable Terrain** or **Blocking Terrain**, through another combatant, or into an illegal position unless the rule explicitly allows it. Move the target as far along the forced movement path as possible and stop them at the last legal position.

If **Impassable Terrain**, **Blocking Terrain**, or another combatant causes the target to stop early, the target suffers a **Collision**. A stop caused only by another restriction is not a **Collision**. A **Collision** deals no damage by itself; a rule that deals **Collision** damage says so.

A battlefield edge stops movement unless a scenario allows that combatant to leave through it during voluntary movement or the rule causing the movement explicitly allows them to leave. Stopping at a battlefield edge is not a **Collision** or **Falling** unless a rule identifies that edge as a physical obstacle or drop.

A missing supporting surface beyond an edge, including a chasm or pit assigned **Impassable Terrain**, does not stop forced movement. If forced movement would carry a target beyond that edge, move them to the edge point along the forced movement path, then resolve **Falling** from that point after the forced movement ends. This is not a **Collision**.

If forced movement moves a target into hazardous terrain or another rule-defined danger, resolve that hazard after the forced movement ends.

> *Example: An effect pushes a Skeleton 3" directly away from the effect's source, toward a ledge that lies 2" along the forced movement path. The missing surface beyond the ledge does not stop the forced movement. The Skeleton moves 2" to the edge point, the forced movement ends, and the Skeleton then resolves **Falling** from that point.*

- **Pack Hunter:** Deal an additional **1 damage of that attack's primary damage type** when attacking a target already engaged by an ally.

### Deep Elf

*Deep elves are a crueller branch of the elder blood, raised on night, venom, and treachery taught as a fine art. They are graceful and dangerous, and far more at ease beneath the dark than beneath the sun.*

**Base Ability Scores:** STR 0, DEX +1, INT +1, SPI -1
**Base HP:** 7
**Sz:** M
**Speed:** 6"
**Senses:** Superior Darkvision
**Luck:** 1

**Traits**

- **Sunlight Sensitivity**
- **Deep Elf Magic:** Choose one Tier 1 Arcane Spell at Hero creation. Once per round, spend **1 Luck Point** to cast that Power for **1 AP** and **0 NRG**, following all normal **Casting Check** rules for that Power. The Hero may cast this Power even if they have no **NRG** pool and no class casting tradition. Use **INT** as the Casting Score. The metal equipment restrictions in **8.2** apply normally.

### Demonborn

*Something infernal stains the demonborn line, whether by old pact, curse, or ancestral trespass. Doors do not open for them, but fire parts, fear bends, and darker powers sometimes answer when they are called.*

**Base Ability Scores:** STR 0, DEX 0, INT +1, SPI +1
**Base HP:** 8
**Sz:** M
**Speed:** 5"
**Senses:** Darkvision
**Luck:** 0

**Traits**

- **Infernal Resistance**
- **Fiendish Legacy:** Choose one at Hero creation:
  - **Ash Tongue: Checks** to resist fire and smoke are rolled with **Advantage**.
  - **Cruel Insight: SPI Checks** made to resist **Frightened** and enemy effects that would force your movement, attacks, or target choices are rolled with **Advantage**.
  - **Hellstep [1 AP]: Shift 3"**.

### Drakeblood

*The drakeblood carry the remnant of an older majesty in the blood, as blessing, burden, or half-remembered debt. The world is fallen, but power still answers them in the old language of flame, storm, and scale.*

**Base Ability Scores:** STR +1, DEX 0, INT 0, SPI +1
**Base HP:** 8
**Sz:** M
**Speed:** 5"
**Luck:** 1

**Traits**

- **Draconic Resistance:** Choose acid, fire, ice, lightning, or poison. This Hero is **Resistant** to that damage type.
- **Breath Weapon [2 AP]:** Once per round, make a **SPI Check** to project either a **Cone 6"** or **Line 6"** originating from your space, using the damage type chosen for **Draconic Resistance**. On a success, affected enemies suffer **1d6** damage of that type.

## 6.10 Backgrounds

Choose one background or roll **1d20** on the **Random Background Table**.

### Random Background Table (d20)

| d20 | Background |
|---|---|
| 1 | Farmer |
| 2 | Nomad |
| 3 | Sailor |
| 4 | Soldier |
| 5 | Smuggler |
| 6 | Courier |
| 7 | Scout |
| 8 | Performer |
| 9 | Artisan |
| 10 | Scholar |
| 11 | Apprentice |

## 7.8 Melee Weapons

*Many of the arms below carry names from an older, wider world than the Bastions now remember: the long-bladed messer, the notched sword-breaker, the throwing cross, the bladed scourge, the weighted cord, and the hook-and-chain. They reach the Dying Lands as salvage, tribute, and trade goods, carried up the southern routes through Saltspire and bartered onward through Reedmarch. How a blade is named changes nothing about how it cuts. Each is listed here under the name the traders used.*

**Unarmed Combat** is a universal attack profile, not an item. A Hero may use it only while both hands are free. It cannot be bought, sold, carried, lost, disarmed, or enhanced unless a rule explicitly says otherwise.

Damage type abbreviations in weapon tables: **(B)** blunt, **(P)** piercing, **(S)** slashing, **(F)** fire, **(I)** ice, **(L)** lightning, **(N)** necrotic, **(H)** holy, **(Ar)** arcane, **(Po)** poison, **(Ps)** psychic.

| Weapon | Cost (c) | Hands | STR Req | DEX Req | Damage | Traits |
|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|
| Unarmed Combat | 0 | 2 | - | - | 1 (B) | **Trip** |
| Club | 0 | 1 | - | - | 1d4 (B) | - |
| Mace | 2 | 1 | 2 | - | 1d6 (B) | **Parrying** |
| Morningstar | 6 | 1 | 2 | - | 1d8 (B) | **Deadly** |
| Flail | 10 | 1 | 3 | - | 1d8 (B) | **Sweep**, **Trip** |
| War Maul | 24 | 2 | 4 | - | 1d12 (B) | **Fatal**, **Heavy** |
| Greathammer | 30 | 2 | 5 | - | 1d12+1 (B) | **Fatal**, **Heavy** |
| Dagger | 1 | 1 | - | - | 1d4 (P) | **Agile**, **Finesse**, **Light** |
| Stiletto | 2 | 1 | 1 | 2 | 1d4 (P) | **Deadly**, **Finesse**, **Light** |
| Shortsword | 5 | 1 | 2 | 1 | 1d6 (S) | **Light**, **Parrying** |
| Rapier | 8 | 1 | - | 3 | 1d8 (P) | **Agile**, **Finesse**, **Parrying** |
| Estoc | 19 | 1/2 | 3 | 2 | 1d8/1d10 (P) | **Fatal**, **Finesse**, **Versatile** |
| Baselard | 6 | 1 | 2 | 2 | 1d6 (S) | **Agile**, **Light**, **Parrying** |
| Sabre | 8 | 1 | 2 | 4 | 1d8 (S) | **Agile**, **Finesse**, **Light**, **Parrying** |
| Scimitar | 7 | 1 | 2 | 3 | 1d8 (S) | **Agile**, **Finesse**, **Graze** |
| Longsword | 12 | 1/2 | 3 | - | 1d8/1d10 (S) | **Parrying**, **Versatile** |
| Bastard Sword | 30 | 1/2 | 4 | - | 1d10/1d12 (S) | **Parrying**, **Versatile** |
| Langes Messer | 19 | 1/2 | 3 | 2 | 1d8/1d10 (S) | **Deadly**, **Parrying**, **Versatile** |
| Great Falchion | 8 | 2 | 3 | 1 | 1d10 (S) | **Graze**, **Sweep** |
| Flamberge | 42 | 2 | 5 | - | 1d12+1 (S) | **Deadly**, **Graze**, **Heavy**, **Parrying** |
| Zweihander | 48 | 2 | 6 | 1 | 1d12+2 (S) | **Cleave**, **Fatal**, **Heavy** |
| Claymore | 24 | 2 | 5 | - | 1d12 (S) | **Cleave**, **Graze**, **Heavy** |
| Battleaxe | 18 | 1/2 | 3 | - | 1d8/1d10 (S) | **Cleave**, **Parrying**, **Versatile** |
| Greataxe | 36 | 2 | 4 | - | 1d12+1 (S) | **Cleave**, **Fatal**, **Heavy** |
| Handaxe | 1 | 1 | 1 | 1 | 1d6 (S) | **Light**, **Thrown** |
| Throwing Cross | 5 | 1 | - | 4 | 1d6 (S) | **Agile**, **Deadly**, **Thrown** |
| Billhook | 6 | 1 | 1 | 2 | 1d6 (S) | **Agile**, **Light**, **Trip** |
| War Pick | 6 | 1 | 2 | - | 1d8 (P) | **Fatal**, **Parrying** |
| Glaive | 10 | 2 | 3 | 1 | 1d10 (S) | **Graze**, **Reach**, **Sweep** |

## Tier 5 Legendary Artifact Weapons (APL 9–10)

**1 Sirrach's Tooth (Zweihander)**
**Cost (c)** 124 **Damage** 1d12+2 (N)
**Traits** **Cleave**, **Fatal**, **Heavy**
**Rule:** A target of a non-**Total Miss** attack with this weapon cannot gain **HP** until the end of their next activation. When you reduce an enemy to **0 HP**, gain **Advantage** on your next attack damage roll or **Check** before the end of your next activation.

**2 Mordain's Hammer (War Maul)**
**Cost (c)** 126 **Damage** 1d12 (B) **Traits** **Fatal**, **Heavy**
**Rule:** Ignores up to **3 AV**. On a **Critical Hit**, the target immediately loses **1 AP** and is knocked **Prone**.

**3 The Sun-Eater (Greatbow)**
**Cost (c)** 128 **Damage** 1d10 (H)
**Traits** **Deadly**, **Heavy**, **Ranged**
**Rule:** Deals **holy** damage. On a **Critical Hit**, the target also suffers **1d6 necrotic damage** and an additional **2d10 holy damage**.

**4 Whisper (Stiletto)**
**Cost (c)** 124 **Damage** 1d4 (P)
**Traits** **Deadly**, **Finesse**, **Light**
**Rule:** If you attack a target while **Hidden**, that attack deals an additional **2 damage of that attack's primary damage type** and ignores up to **2 AV**. A melee attack with this weapon against a **Sleeping** target ignores all **AV**.

**5 The World-Breaker (Claymore)**
**Cost (c)** 128 **Damage** 1d12 (S)
**Traits** **Cleave**, **Graze**, **Heavy**
**Rule:** **[1 AP]:** Destroy one terrain piece, door, or wall segment within your melee distance, leaving its area as **Difficult Terrain**.

**6 The Returning Spear of Salttide (Spear)**
**Cost (c)** 126 **Damage** 1d6/1d8 (L)
**Traits** **Reach**, **Thrown**, **Versatile**
**Rule:** **Thrown** attacks with this weapon ignore **Cover**, but still require **LOS**. After each **Thrown** attack resolves, this weapon instantly teleports back to your hand and becomes available for other uses. It can make only one **Thrown** attack per activation and is never lost because of a **Total Miss** or **Critical Failure**.

**7 Maelthorn's Chain (Hook-and-Chain)**
**Cost (c)** 124 **Damage** 1d6 (F)
**Traits** **Agile**, **Entangle**, **Reach**, **Trip**
**Rule:** A target made **Immobilized** by this weapon's **Entangle** trait suffers **2d6 fire damage** at the end of the round and cannot become **Hidden** or **Invisible**.

**8 The Hollow Crown's Edge (Longsword)**
**Cost (c)** 124 **Damage** 1d8/1d10 (S)
**Traits** **Deadly**, **Parrying**, **Versatile**
**Rule:** The first time each round you would be reduced below **1 HP** while you still have at least **1 AP** remaining, you are reduced to **1 HP** instead and lose all remaining **AP**.

**9 Void-Weaver (Quarterstaff)**
**Cost (c)** 122 **Damage** 1d6 (Ar) **Traits** **Parrying**, **Trip**
**Rule:** While this artifact is equipped, all **Arcane Spells** you cast cost **1 less NRG**, and you may reroll one natural **1** on a **Casting Check** for an **Arcane Spell**.

**10 The Sevenfold Star (Throwing Cross)**
**Cost (c)** 124 **Damage** 1d6 (Ar)
**Traits** **Agile**, **Deadly**, **Thrown**
**Rule:** **Thrown** attacks with this weapon have **Range 12"**. After each **Thrown** attack resolves, it returns to your hand and becomes available for other uses. It can make only one **Thrown** attack per activation and is never lost because of a **Total Miss** or **Critical Failure**. On a **Critical Hit**, choose up to two other enemies within **3"** of the target; each suffers **1d6 arcane damage**.

## Tier 5 Legendary Artifact Armour and Shields (d20)

**1 Sunforged Full Plate**
**Equipment Type** Chest **AD/AV** d12+5 **STR** 8 **DEX** -
**INT** - **SPI** - **DEX Pen** -5 **Max Speed** 5" **Cost (c)** 128
**Description:** You are **Resistant** to **fire** and **holy**. You are a **Light Source** with **Aura 4"**, and enemies cannot become **Hidden** while within it.

**2 Frostheart Full Plate**
**Equipment Type** Chest **AD/AV** d12+5 **STR** 8 **DEX** -
**INT** - **SPI** - **DEX Pen** -5 **Max Speed** 5" **Cost (c)** 128
**Description:** You are **Resistant** to **ice**. You have **Ice Glide**. After a non-**Total Miss** melee attack against you resolves, the attacker becomes **Slowed**.

**3 Thunderlord Plate**
**Equipment Type** Chest **AD/AV** d12+5 **STR** 8 **DEX** -
**INT** - **SPI** - **DEX Pen** -5 **Max Speed** 5" **Cost (c)** 128

shrugs off scattered blows; only focused, concerted effort will bring one down. Their kind are rare and terrible, and seldom seen in numbers.

## Entry Structure

Each Monster entry is laid out in the order the Monster acts, so it can be read from top to bottom during play:

1. **Name and Role.** The Monster's name, with their battlefield Role in brackets.
2. **Description.** A short passage of lore and physical description, set in italics.
3. **Stat Line.** The table of HP, AV, SPD, LVL, CV, and Sz described above.
4. **AI Steps.** If the Monster has them, their numbered AI Steps appear here. When the Monster activates, they follow the Monster AI rules and attempt each AI Step in order. A step marked (on d6 N+) is attempted only if a d6 rolled for it shows N or higher.
5. **Attacks.** The Monster's attacks. If they have the Multi-Attack ability, that ability is listed first, since it governs how the attacks below it are made.
6. **Special Abilities.** The Monster's remaining abilities. Movement abilities, such as **Fly** or **Climb**, are always listed first.

Many Monsters share common abilities. A stat block may print their full rules or list them by name; **9.6 Universal Special Abilities** is authoritative.

## Greenmark Bestiary

### Giant Tarantula [Skirmisher]

*A hand-span of bristled legs around a body the size of a war helm, the giant tarantula stalks the Greenmark's leaf litter on stilted, deliberate steps. Its fangs weep a venom that turns a victim's muscles to wet rope. It spins no snares, preferring to run prey down and pin it where it falls. Foragers keep one eye on the canopy, because the largest specimens hunt from above and drop.*

| HP | AV | SPD | LVL | CV | Sz |
|---|---|---|---|---|---|
| 9 | 0 | 6" | 1 | 1c | S |

**Attacks**

- **Bite:** 1d6 + 2 piercing damage.

**Special Abilities**

- **Small.**
- **Beast.**
- **Wallcrawler:** This Monster's listed **Speed** applies equally to vertical surfaces. They may move along walls and ceilings without spending additional movement for **Climb** and without making **STR Checks** to **Climb**. They cannot be knocked **Prone** while clinging to a vertical or overhanging surface.
- **Venom:** When this Monster's melee attack damages a target, that target must pass a **STR Check** or become **Poisoned [d4]**.
- **Standing Leap (6").**
- **Tremorsense (9").**

### Goblin [Minion]

*Knee-high, green-grey, and all elbows and malice, goblins infest the Greenmark's ruined steadings in chittering mobs. Each carries a notched blade and a sling of river stones, and not one will hold a line once the fight turns against it. Singly they are cowards; in numbers they are a tide. Greythorn's gatewardens read goblin-sign in the chewed bones left along the road.*

| HP | AV | SPD | LVL | CV | Sz |
|---|---|---|---|---|---|
| 6 | 0 | 6" | 1 | 1c | S |

**Attacks**

- **Jagged Blade:** 1d4 slashing damage.
- **Short Sling: Ranged 8"**, 1d4 + 1 blunt damage.

**Special Abilities**

- **Small.**
- **Nimble:** After making an attack, they use **Shift 1"** toward the nearest **Cover Terrain**, avoiding hazards.
- **Darkvision (9").**

### Beastman [Minion]

*All fur and grievance, a beastman is a hunched man-shape topped with the head of a goat or boar, its hands ending in black claws. They run the forest edge in warbands, raiding for meat and metal, and there is nothing in them that will parley. They were among the first things the burning years shaped, and they have bred true down every generation since.*

**Tiebreaker:** If no party escapes with the Pelt and total Boar damage is also tied, the party with the most total Coin Value from all other sources wins.

### Scenario 2: The Whispering Grove

*The grove is older than Greythorn and older than the western forest road that skirts it. The standing stones hum when no wind passes, and pale lights move between them on moonless nights. Greythorn's farmers leave bread there and do not look back. Scholars call it a site of power. The Council of Captains calls it part of the tithe, and pays it without complaint.*

**Primary Objective:** Be the party that has successfully activated the most Standing Stones by the end of Round 7.

**Final Random Monster Groups:** Determine using **10.6.4**.

**Awake Groups:** Random Monster Groups begin **Resting** unless a listed setup rule says otherwise. Scenario-specific Monsters use their listed state.

**Minion Swarm:** No.

**Objective Scaling:** Apply **10.6.9** to the Standing Stones. A majority is more than half the number placed.

**Level Scaling:** Use the Scenario APL for every APL-based Monster, hazard, objective, reward, and damage value in this scenario.

**Solo/Co-op Objective:** Activate a majority of the Standing Stones placed after scaling, then extract at least 1 Hero through any battlefield edge.

**Pressure Clock:** Use **Swarm** from **10.5.7**.

**Battlefield and Terrain (36"×36"):** Place 3–5 Tree area terrain pieces and 6–7 Undergrowth patches around the battlefield edges, leaving a Central Clearing (about 12–15" diameter) at the battlefield's centre. Within the Clearing, place 3 **Standing Stone** markers (1"×1") in a rough triangle, each 6–8" apart.

**Objective Placement:** The 3 Standing Stones are the Primary Objectives. Place 2 Treasure Chests (**1 Treasure roll with Disadvantage** each) within dense forest sections near different battlefield edges, at least 8" from any Stone.

#### Scenario-Specific Monster: Antlered Warden

*Not Old Wode themselves. Old Wode does not stir for small intrusions. The Antlered Warden is the agreement's enforcement arm: a figure woven from the grove's oldest growth, robed in bark and grey moss, with antlers that have more branches than any natural animal. It does not speak. It does not negotiate. It maintains the terms.*

| | |
|---|---|
| **HP** | (5 × Party Size × (2 + (1 × APL))) / 8 |
| **AV** | 1 + (APL/3, rounded down) |
| **SPD** | 6" (ignores forest **Difficult Terrain**) |
| **LVL** | APL (min 2, max 5) |
| **CV** | (2 + (4 × APL)) Coins |
| **Sz** | L |

**AI Steps**

**Target Priority:** Prioritize the valid Hero who most recently activated or attempted to activate a Standing Stone. Otherwise, use the normal Monster target priorities.

1. **Entangling Roots:** If the **Primary Target** is within **8"** and is not **Immobilized**, that enemy must pass a **DEX Check** or become **Immobilized**. Then end this activation.

**Attacks**

- **Thorny Vine Lash: Reach**, 1d6 + APL/2 slashing damage.
- **Mystic Bolt:** 1d4 + APL psychic damage, **Ranged 10"**.

**Special Abilities**

- **Fey Resistance:** This Monster is **Resistant** to **arcane** damage, and is **Immune** to **Frightened** and **Sleeping**.

**Boss Deployment:** Not yet placed at setup. When a Hero first Interacts with a Standing Stone, place the Antlered Warden adjacent to that Stone. The Antlered Warden is **Awake** when placed.

**Random Monster Setup:**

you instead gain **Advantage** on the first **Setup Roll-off**, search, or scenario **Interact Check** made by your party during that adventure.

### 11.2.5 Hirelings

During the **Town Phase**, your party may recruit persistent **Hirelings** into its **Stronghold** roster. A Hireling remains on that roster until they are slain, dismissed during a **Town Phase**, or removed by a specific rule.

Hirelings are purchased with **Treasury** funds during the **Town Phase**. Recruiting a Hireling costs **1 TAP** and their listed coin cost.

Hirelings require no recurring upkeep once recruited. A party's **Stronghold** roster may contain no more than **8 Hirelings** total, including Animal Companions. A Hireling may be dismissed for no TAP cost during the Town Phase; a dismissed Hireling is removed permanently and grants no refund.

#### Active Hirelings and Summon Limits

At the start of each adventure, after choosing the Heroes who will take part in that adventure, choose which Hirelings from your **Stronghold** roster will deploy with that party.

The maximum number of active Hirelings for that adventure is determined by the number of Heroes in that party at the start of the adventure.

| Heroes in the Party | Maximum Active Hirelings | Per-Hero Control Limit |
|---:|---:|---:|
| **4** | **4** | **1** per Hero |
| **3** | **3** | **1** per Hero |
| **2** | **4** | **2** per Hero |
| **1** | **3** | **3** for that Hero |

These limits are checked only when the adventure begins. They do not recalculate later in that adventure if one or more Heroes are removed from play.

When you choose active Hirelings for an adventure, assign each active Hireling to a specific Hero in that party. That assignment is locked for the duration of the adventure.

A Hireling may only be assigned to a Hero whose printed **SPI** is equal to or greater than that Hireling's listed **Min SPI** value.

Use the Hero's printed **SPI** on their Hero sheet. Temporary in-adventure modifiers do not change which Hirelings that Hero may control.

Hirelings, including Animal Companions, do not count against the party-wide limit of **2** active allied Summons. See **2.5.1 Summon Limits**.

#### Specialist Hireling Roster

These are trained mortal retainers recruited into the party's **Stronghold** roster.

**Porter**
**Min SPI** 2 **Cost** 12c **SPD** 6" **Sz** M **HP** 6 **AV** 0
**Attack** None
**Special Abilities:** Cannot attack. May use **Interact** to pick up, carry, transfer, drop, and extract one treasure chest, relic, or other bulky objective as though they were a **Hero**. This permission does not allow them to control or score any other objective. **Drag [1 AP]:** Move one adjacent **Knocked Out** Hero **2"**.

**Torchbearer**
**Min SPI** 2 **Cost** 16c **SPD** 6" **Sz** M **HP** 5 **AV** 0
**Attack** None
**Special Abilities:** Counts as a **Light Source** while on the battlefield.

**Squire**
**Min SPI** 3 **Cost** 32c **SPD** 6" **Sz** M **HP** 10 **AV** 1
**Attack** **Shortsword: 1d6 slashing damage**
**Special Abilities:** **Assist:** While adjacent to a Hero, that Hero gains **+1 AV**.

**Sellsword**
**Min SPI** 4 **Cost** 40c **SPD** 6" **Sz** M **HP** 8 **AV** 1
**Attack** **Shortsword: 1d6 slashing damage**
**Special Abilities:** **Round Shield:** Gain **d6 AD** when using **Block**.

**Apothecary**
**Min SPI** 4 **Cost** 44c **SPD** 6" **Sz** M **HP** 7 **AV** 0
**Attack** None
**Special Abilities:** **Remedy [2 AP]:** One adjacent Hero regains **2 HP** and removes **Poisoned [dX]**.

**Archer**
**Min SPI** 4 **Cost** 48c **SPD** 7" **Sz** M **HP** 7 **AV** 0
**Attack** **Shortbow: 1d6 piercing damage, 16"**
**Special Abilities:** **Steady Shot:** The first ranged attack this Hireling resolves each round ignores **Cover**.

## C.5 Reactions Summary

A **Reaction** is an action taken when a rule's stated trigger occurs, usually outside the reacting combatant's activation. A combatant may take a **Reaction** during their own activation if its trigger occurs then. Taking a **Reaction** does not begin or end an activation. To take a **Reaction**, a combatant must have enough unspent AP to pay their cost. **Heroes** and **Hirelings** may use **Reactions** unless a rule says otherwise. Allied **Summons** may use **Reactions** only if a rule explicitly grants that **Summon Reactions**. **Monsters** do not take **Reactions** unless a rule explicitly allows them. A combatant may take multiple **Reactions** in the same round if they have enough unspent AP and a legal trigger, but may take only one **Reaction** in response to the same action or effect. For each affected combatant, only 1 Reaction may be declared by that combatant or on their behalf to modify how the source resolves against them; if 2 or more would do so, the affected combatant's controller chooses which one is declared, and the others spend no costs. A Reaction used by the source's controller to modify the source's own roll does not count against an affected combatant's limit. A Reaction resolves immediately when declared unless its rule or a resolution sequence assigns a later timing. A Reaction that grants a separate action still uses the reacting combatant's one-Reaction limit, but does not prevent a different combatant from reacting unless both Reactions would modify the source against the same affected combatant. If no rule grants an allied **Summon Reactions**, their unspent AP cannot be spent on **Reactions** and is discarded at the end of the round.

| Reaction | AP Cost | Trigger | Effect |
|---|---|---|---|
| **Block** | [1 AP] | An attack or effect would deal **blunt**, **piercing**, or **slashing** damage to you while you have an equipped shield and can take **Reactions**. | Roll your shield's **AD**, if any, and add its flat **AV** to the **AV** you already apply against that source. |

# Index

*Main entries follow the terms of C.11 Glossary of Terms and Conditions. Locators point to the glossary entry, the sections it cites, and sections that define or apply the term.*


## A

**Acid**, 423
**Active Party**, 362, 423
**Adamantine**, 91, 423
**Adjacent**, 423
**Advantage**, 13, 92, 423
**Adventure Preparation**, 254
**Aftermath**. *See* Aftermath Phase
**Aftermath Phase**, 366, 422, 423
**AI Step**, 184, 424, 434
**Allied**, 352, 424
**Ally**, 424
**Ancestries**
- Deep Elf, 65
- Demonborn, 65
- Drakeblood, 65
- Dwarf, 63
- Elf, 63
- Gnome, 64
- Goblin, 64
- Halfling, 63
- Human, 63
- Orc, 64
- Ratkin, 64

**AP**, 10, 31, 35, 36, 83, 424
**APL**, 85, 92, 93, 357, 424
**Arcane**, 120, 121, 122, 424
**Area of Effect**, 18, 424
**Armour**, 98
**Armour Dice (AD)**, 49, 424
**Armour Value (AV)**, 49, 424
**Attack Sequence**, 46, 419
**Aura**, 14, 18, 424
**Awake**, 180, 182, 358, 424

## B

**Backgrounds**, 65
**Base Damage Dice**, 424
**Basic Mode**, 399
**Beast**, 186, 190, 192, 424
**Bench**, 362, 424
**Bleeding**, 54, 424
**Blinded**, 54, 424
**Block**, 49, 424
**Blocking Terrain**, 23, 425
**Blood Price**, 163, 425
**Blood Surge**, 82, 425
**Blunt**, 420, 425
**Boss**, 425
**Boss Scale**, 189, 425
**Burning**, 54, 425

## C

**Campaign Cycle**, 366
**Carried Objective**, 425
**Caster Supremacy**, 72, 425
**Casting Check**, 425
**Celestial**, 425
**Character Creation**, 59
**Check**, 12, 425
**Classes**
- Assassin, 75
- Berserker, 74
- Cleric, 77
- Druid, 83
- Fighter, 73
- Paladin, 78
- Psion, 80
- Ranger, 76
- Rogue, 74
- Sorcerer, 82
- Trickster, 81
- Wizard, 79

**Climb**, 41, 425
**Coin Value**, 425
**Coins**, 425
**Collision**, 40, 425
**Combatant**, 30, 425
**Cover**, 20, 21, 425, 435
**Cover Terrain**, 17, 23, 426
**Critical Cast**, 147, 152, 426
**Critical Failure**, 426
**Critical Hit**, 47, 139, 426
**Critical Success**, 426
**Cursed**, 54, 338, 426

## D

**Dangerous Terrain**, 25, 426, 438
**Darkness**, 21, 426, 439
**Darkvision**, 62, 426
**Declared State**, 16, 426
**Deep Water**, 25, 426, 439
**DEX Check**, 426
**DEX Pen**, 98, 426
**Difficult Terrain**, 25, 41, 426
**Disadvantage**, 13, 426
**Dodge**, 46, 49, 426

## E

**Elevation**, 26, 426, 439
**Empower**, 147, 149, 150, 427
**End of Round**, 32
**Enemy**, 427
**Engaged**, 183, 427
**Explosion**, 18, 427
**Extract**, 427

## F

**Falling**, 42, 427
**Fiend**, 187, 213, 215, 427
**Finesse**, 94, 401, 402, 404, 427
**Fire**, 427
**Footprint**, 14, 427
**Forced Movement**, 40, 427
**Frightened**, 54, 427

## G

**General Talents**, 69
**Guard Point**, 427

## H

**Heal / Healing**, 427
**Heard the Song**, 189, 233, 427
**Hero**, 52, 59, 60, 427
**Hero Advancement**, 86
**Hidden**, 17, 18, 20, 23, 54, 55, 427
**Hireling**, 427
**Hirelings**, 86
**Holy**, 427
**HP**, 48, 52, 83, 179, 400, 427
**HP loss**, 48, 428
**Huge (H)**, 428